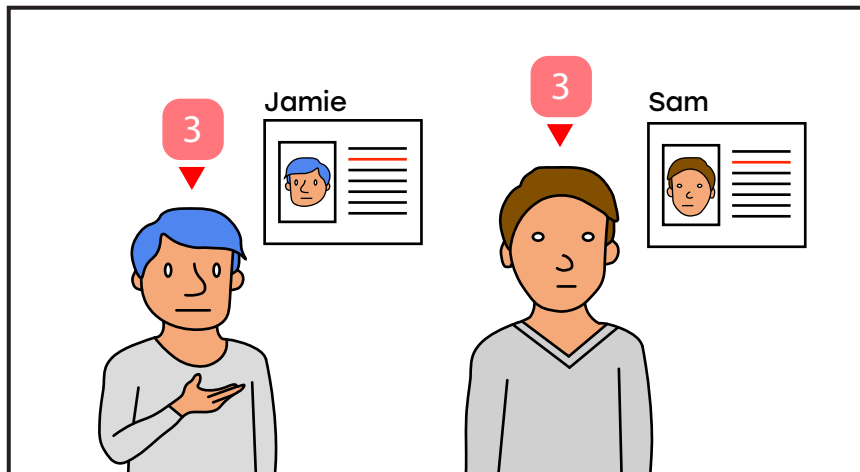
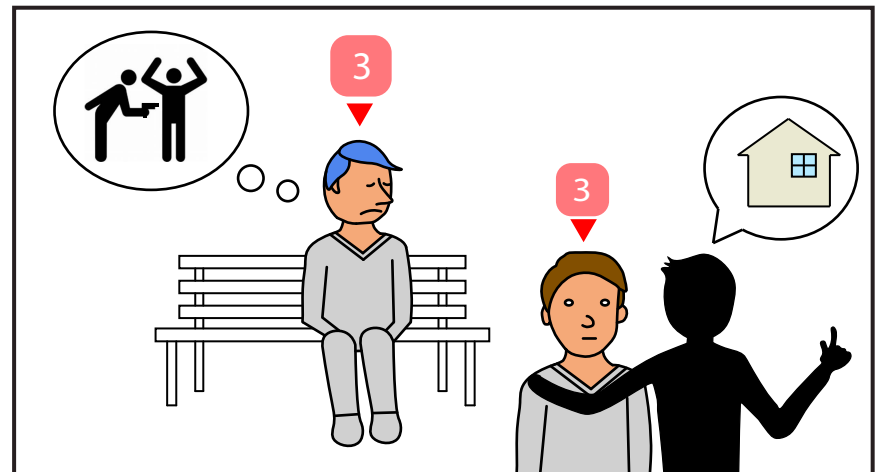
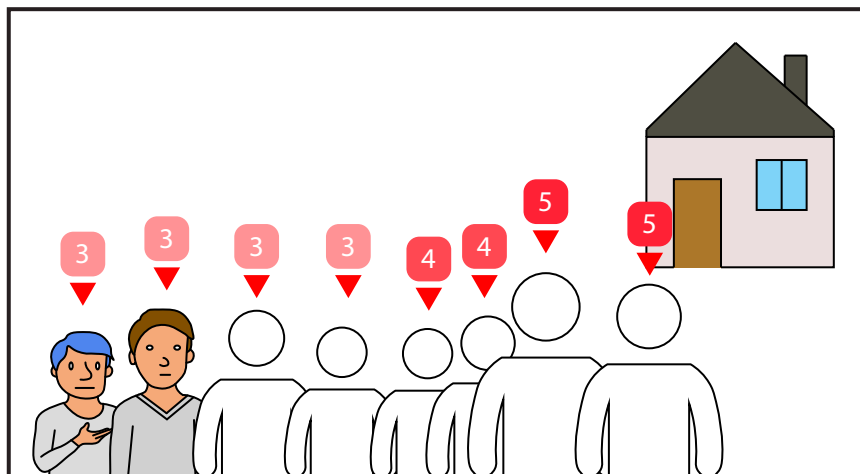




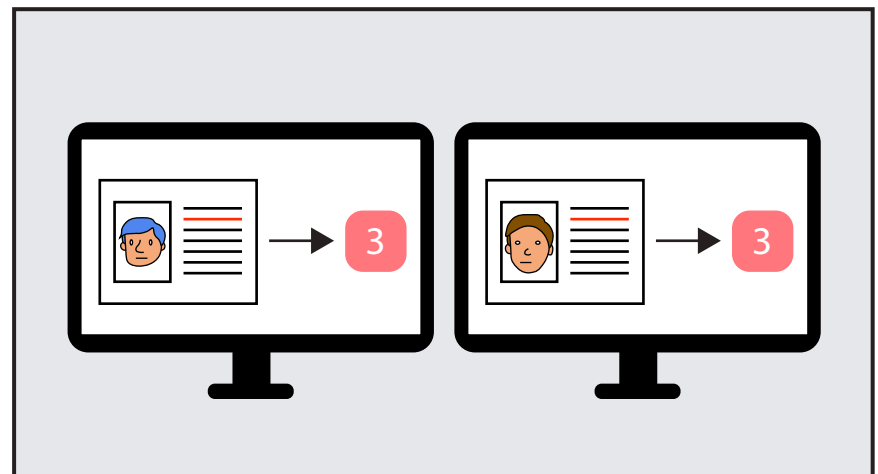
1. Jamie and Sam were experiencing homelessness. They shared the same demographic features and had similar public service records. Accordingly, they received the same score from the computer.



2. One day, Sam fortunately found a place to stay for a while. On the other hand, Jamie got robbed and lost all of his belongings.



3. However, because both of them received a relatively low score from the computer, they need to wait for a long time for housing assistance.



4. The computer is not able to tell when a person needs immediate support because Jamie and Sam look the same to the computer. The score can't reflect each person's real situation.

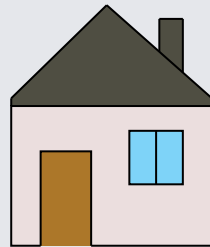
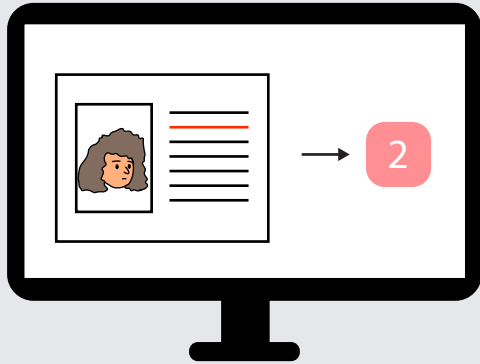
*What do you think should be done to help people in a situation like Jamie and Sam?*



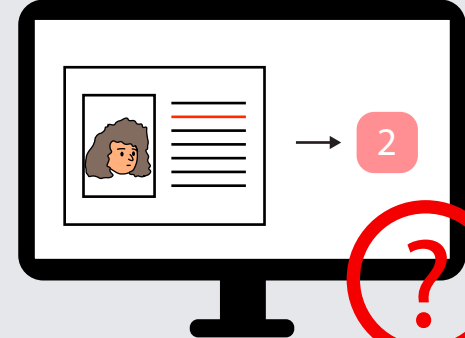
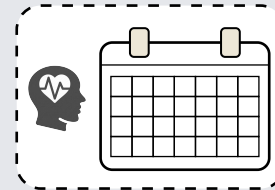
1. Charlie has long been dealing with mental health issues and has been experiencing homelessness for a while.



2. While Charlie is in need of mental health support, Charlie refused to seek help because of the terrible experiences he previously had while in psychiatric hospital.

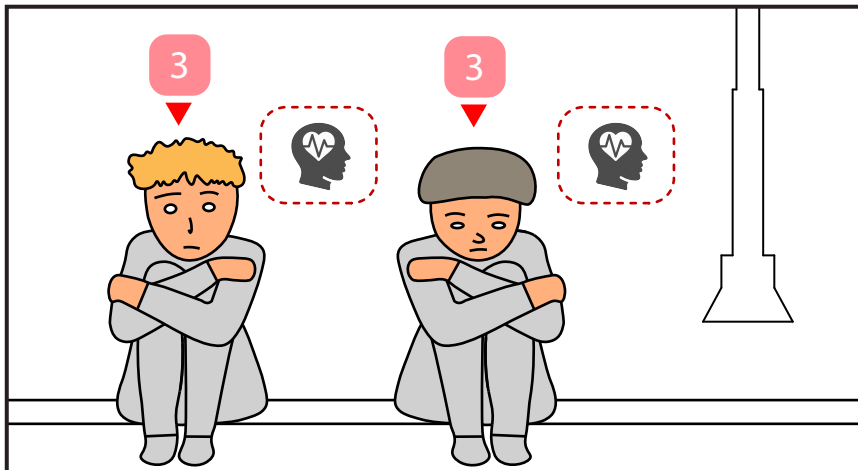


3. When Charlie applies for housing assistance, Charlie receives a relatively low score from the computer.

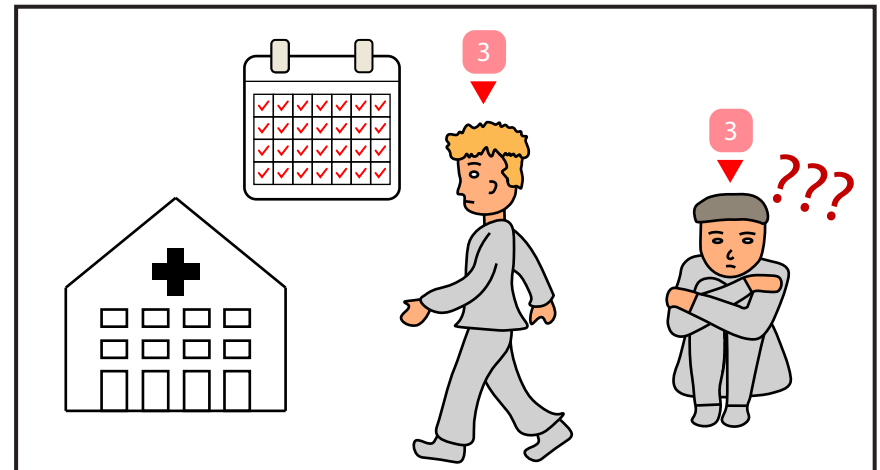


4. Charlie receives a low score because the computer uses mental health in-patient visits as a measure of how vulnerable a person is. However, since Charlie does not have any recent record of mental health visits, she is predicted to be at low risk.

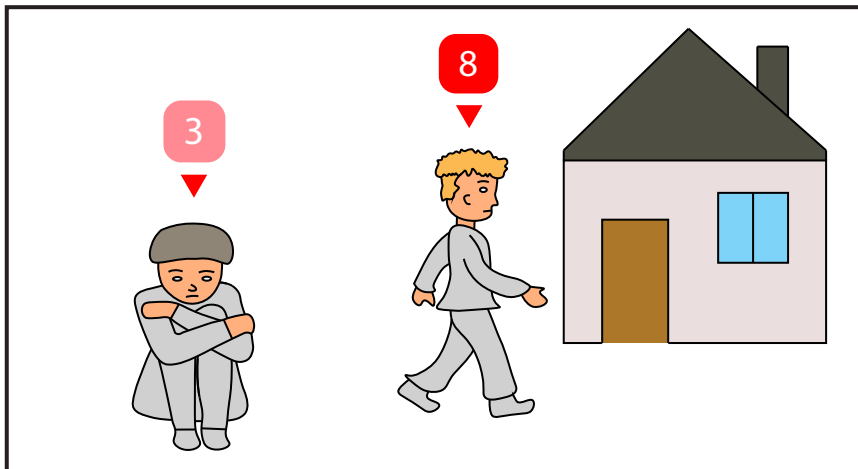
*What do you think should be done to help people in a situation like Charlie?*



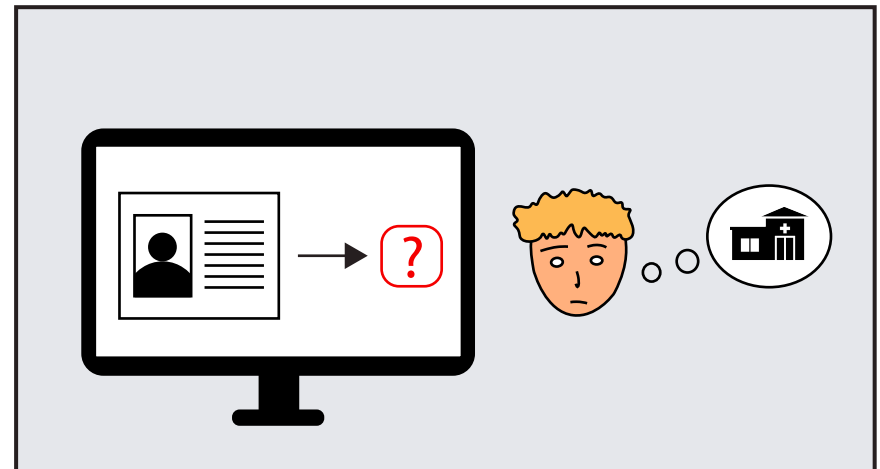
1. Alex was on and off the street for a while. He's dealing with serious mental health challenges and lacks the skills and resources to protect himself. Kai was facing a similar situation as Alex.



2. Alex tries to visit emergency rooms everyday, because he knows the computer would rank people higher if they are more likely to visit emergency rooms. Kai, however, did not know how to boost his score.

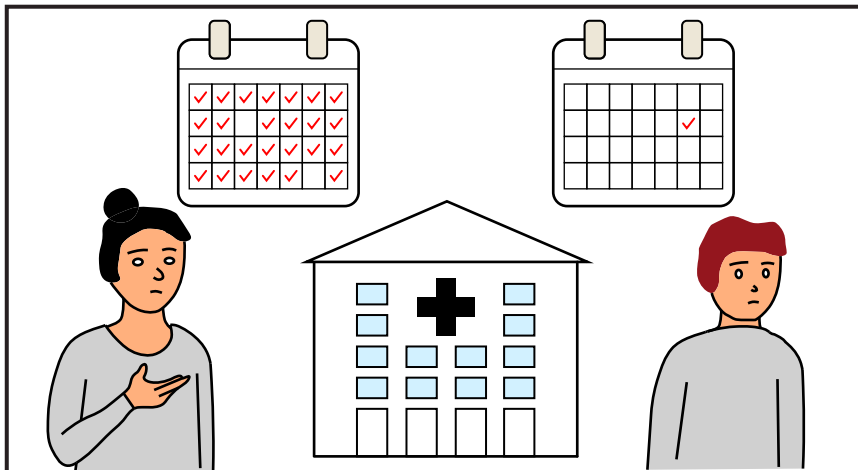


3. As a result, Alex got a higher score than Kai. Alex is housed and Kai isn't, though they both needed housing equally urgently.

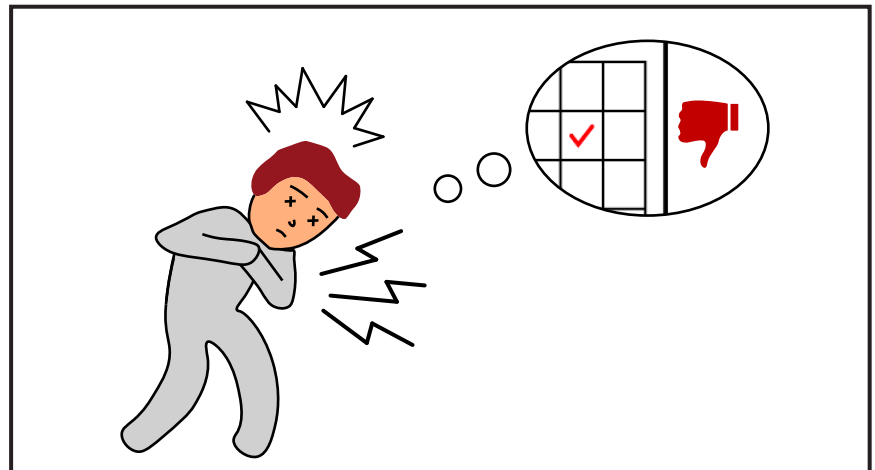


4. The computer used certain rules to predict how vulnerable a person is. However, those rules might be easily gamed if you know how the system works.

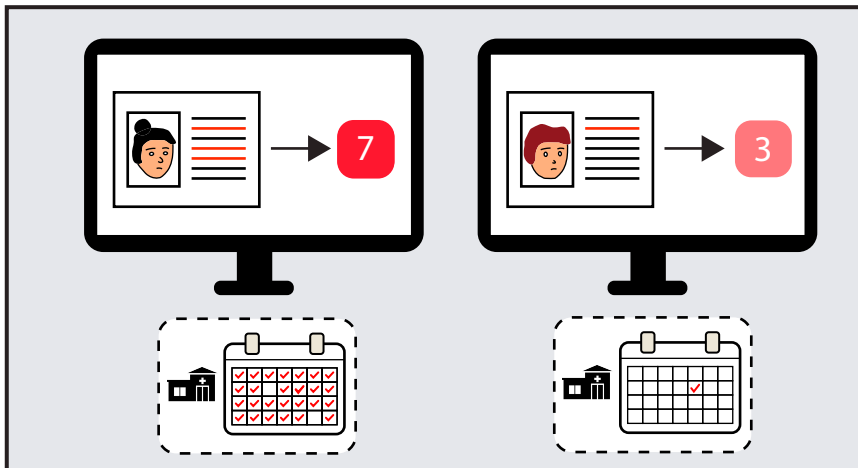
*What do you think should be done to help people in a situation like Alex and Kai?*



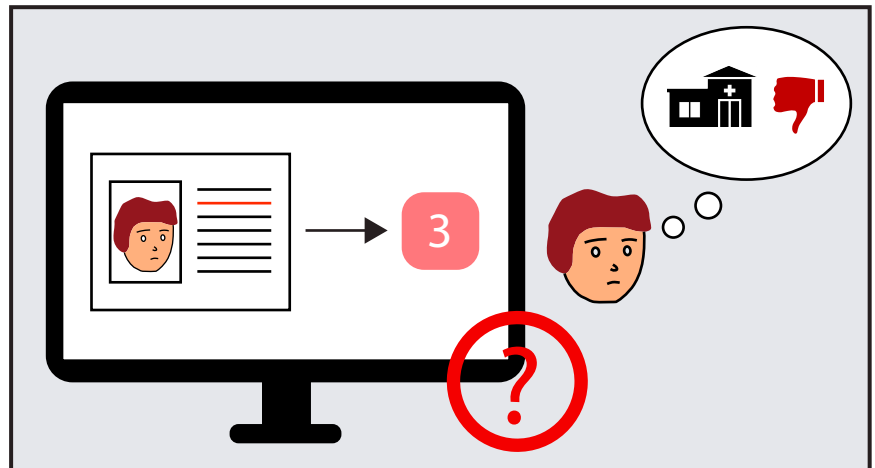
1. Marley went to ER more frequently than Blake this winter. Marley went to emergency rooms in winter to get out of the cold. Blake also went to the emergency room, but only once when he was sent there unconscious.



2. Blake only went to ER once as he hated going to ER for his past traumatic experiences at ER, even though Blake has chronic diseases that require extensive treatment.

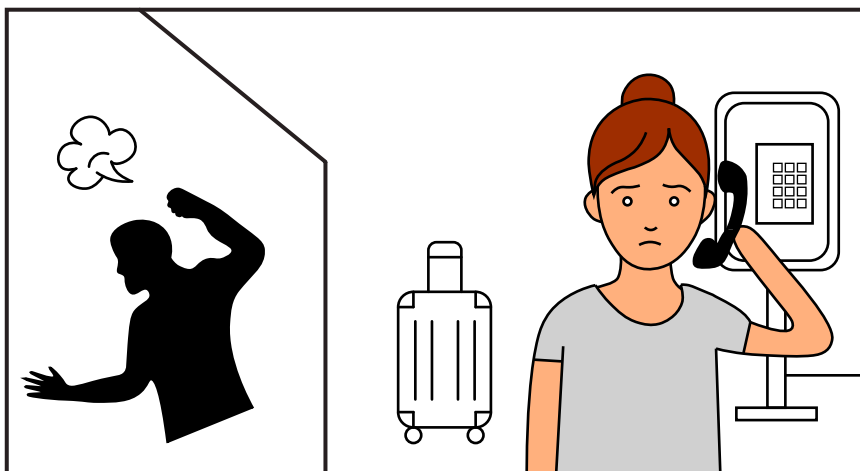


3. The computer gave Marley a higher score than Blake because the computer saw more ER visits for Marley.

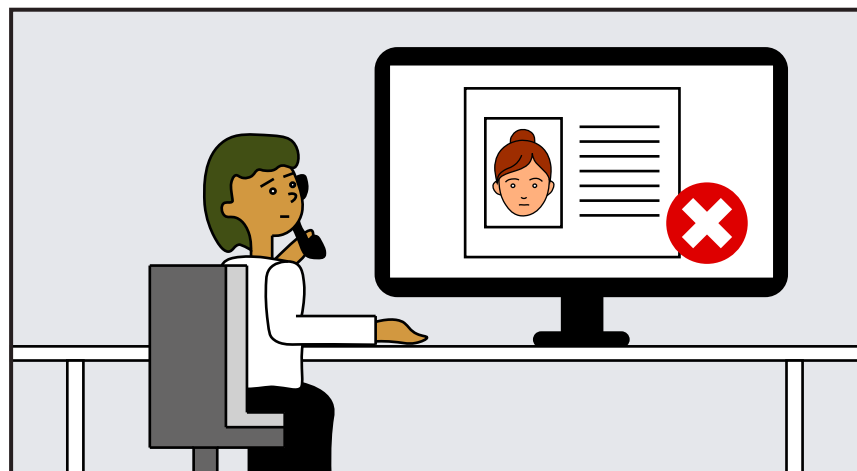


4. The computer can't know the exact reasons behind ER visits as it can only access the ER records.

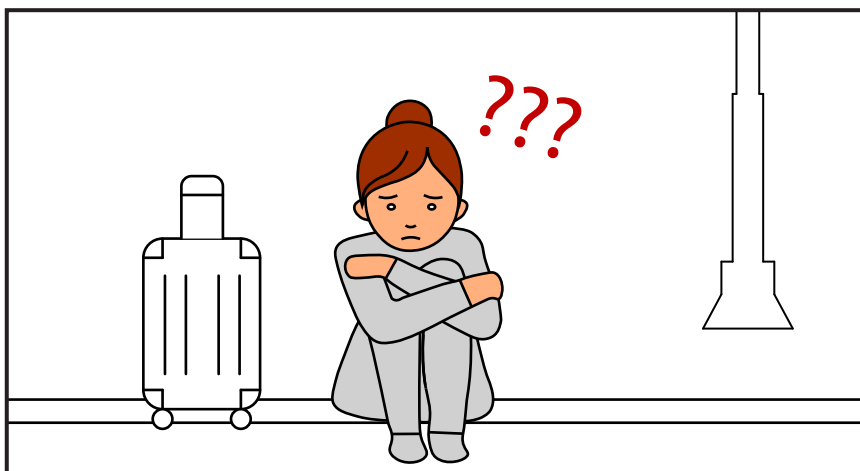
*What do you think should be done to help people in a situation like Marley and Blake?*



1. Jayden recently left an abusive relationship where she was living with her partner. She applied for housing assistance as she was helpless on the street.



2. When they used a computer to decide, Jayden was told that she's not qualified for housing support.

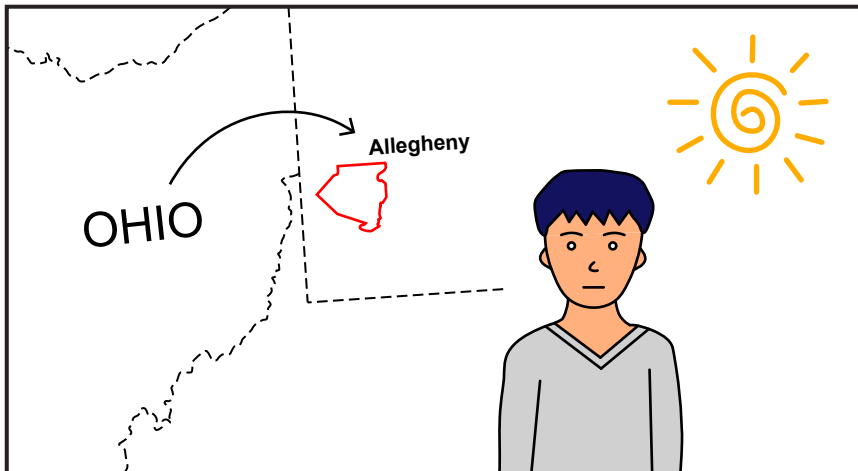


3. Jayden was very upset and wondered how much more she needed to prove herself eligible for housing.

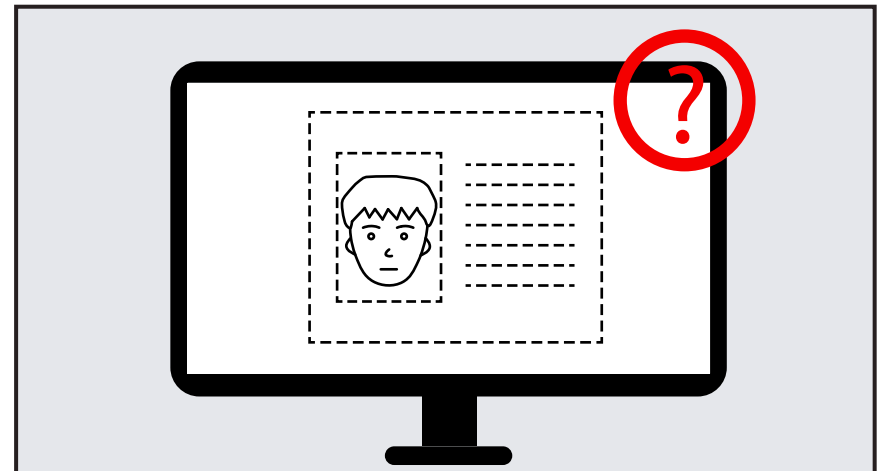


4. When Jayden asked why, the frontline workers did not know why the computer categorized her as unqualified.

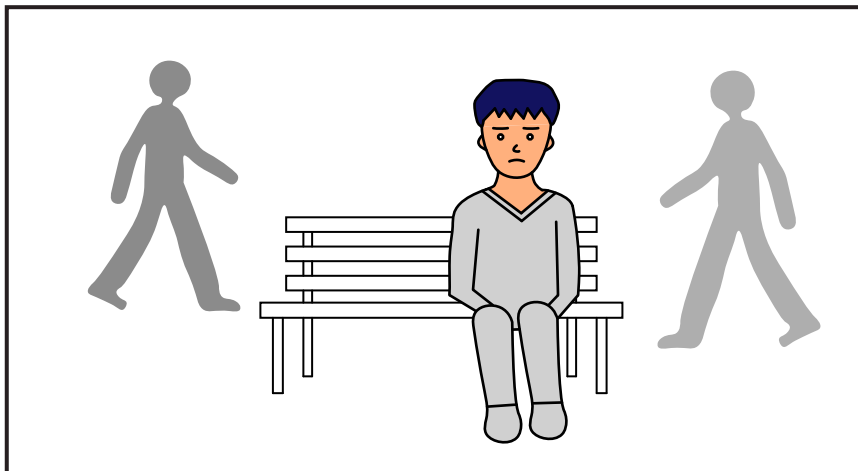
*What do you think should be done to help people in a situation like Jordan?*



1. In the summer, lots of unhoused people travel to the town. One of them is Skylar, who is from Ohio. Skylar was in his 20s suffering from chronic diseases, and had no place to stay. However, the computer gave Skylar a low score.



2. Because Skylar does not hold a record in the county's public service system, and the computer has no knowledge of Skylar. It could only rate Skylar, using the county's data.

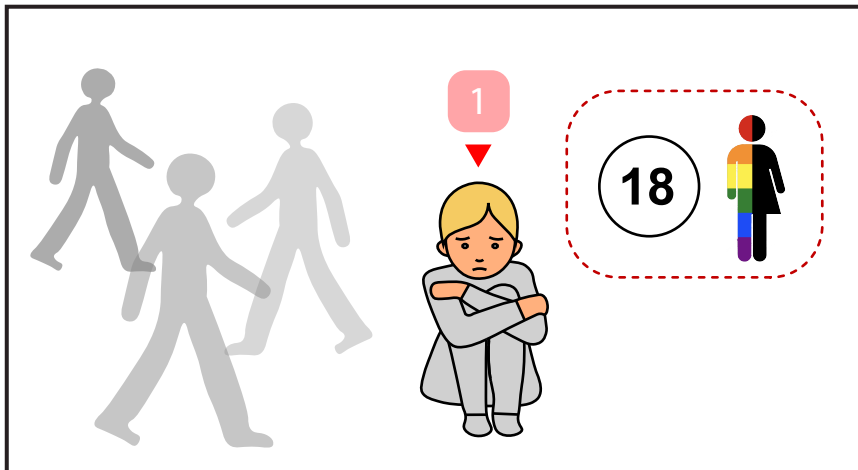


3. As a result, Skylar was not able to get housing support, even though he's very vulnerable.

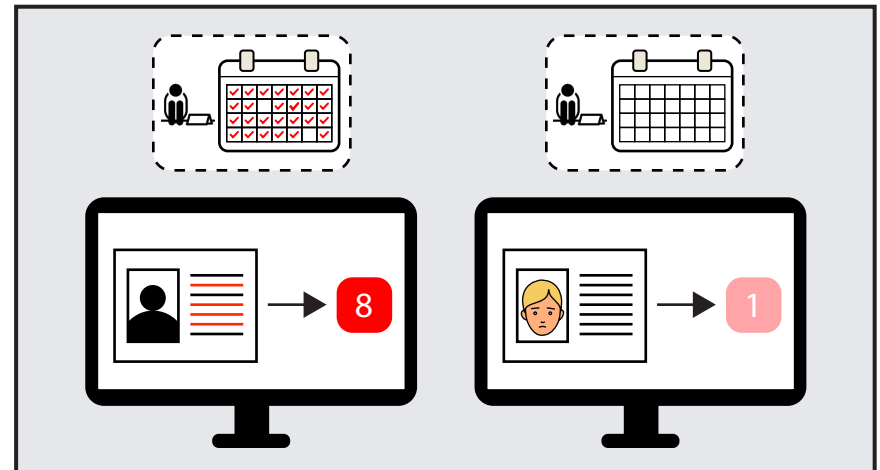


4. The computer makes decisions based on the data available in the county's system. If a person is out of the county's system, it can make wrong decisions.

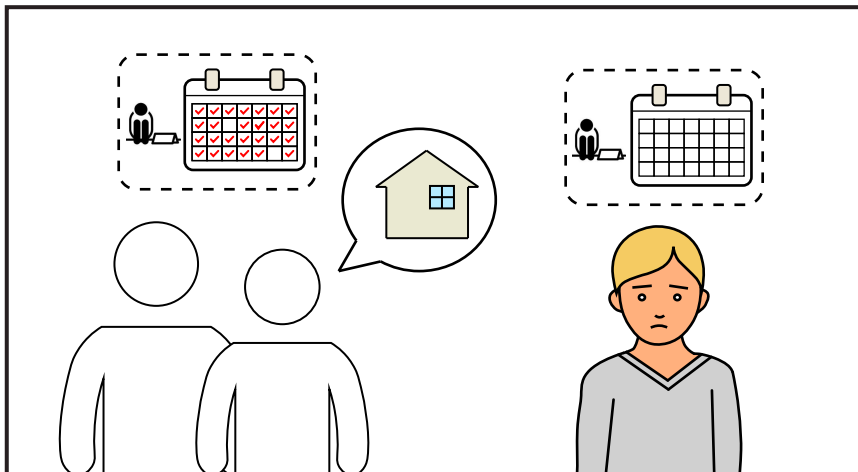
*What do you think should be done to help people in a situation like Skylar?*



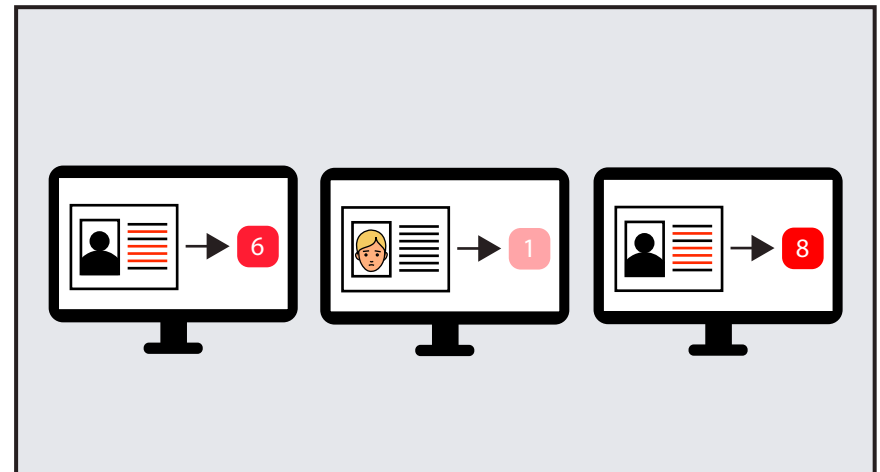
1. Casey was new to the street: He is 18, kicked out of his home because he was transgender. As a trans, he did not know how to protect himself from harassment and violence on the street. However, the computer gave Casey a low score.



2. The computer ranks people with chronic homeless records higher, overlooking newcomers like Casey, who are often younger, who also desperately require immediate support.



3. Although Casey desperately needed help, folks on the street longer would argue that they deserve to be picked up by the computer faster, no matter how vulnerable they are. Given the extremely limited resources, no matter how the computer makes its decision, there will always be folks who are left out.



4. The computer was, therefore, unable to make equally accurate predictions about Casey's vulnerability, compared to the general homeless population.

*What do you think should be done to help people in a situation like Casey?*